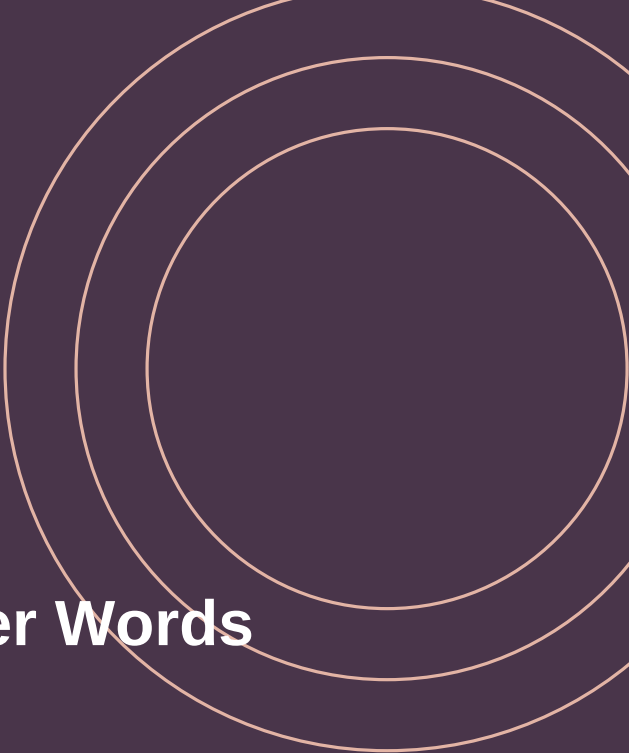




Softer Words

A gratitude and self-talk diary for ordinary hard days

Arden Vellor

THE RITUAL LIBRARY

A note before you begin

This diary is for personal reflection. It is not psychotherapy, crisis support, medical care, or a substitute for support from a qualified professional. Skip any prompt that feels unhelpful and seek appropriate help when needed.

This book makes room for the whole truth: gratitude and grief, progress and pause, tenderness and uncertainty.

Copyright © 2026 Arden Vellor. All rights reserved.

You do not have to earn a kinder voice.

This diary does not ask you to turn every day into a lesson. It asks only: what happened, what helped, and what sentence would make the day gentler to carry?

My believable affirmations

Try sentences that are kind and plausible, not grand.

WORDS THAT FEEL TRUE ENOUGH TO PRACTICE

WHAT I WANT MORE OF IN MY SELF-TALK

Day 1

“What felt tender today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 2

“What did I do with care, even if no one saw it?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 3

“What is one sentence I wish I could hear?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 4

“Where did I make room for myself?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 5

“What did I survive, soften, or begin?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 6

“What deserves less judgment from me?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 7

“What moment was ordinary and still good?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 1 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 8

“What can be true without being fixed tonight?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 9

“How did I protect my energy?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 10

“What did I notice with curiosity?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 11

“What would “kind enough” sound like here?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 12

“What brought even a flicker of ease?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 13

“What did my future self need from me today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 14

“What can I release from the story of this day?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 2 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 15

“What am I learning to trust?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 16

“Where did I choose gentleness over perfection?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 17

“What would I tell someone I love in this exact moment?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 18

“What is one small proof that I kept going?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 19

“What felt tender today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 20

“What did I do with care, even if no one saw it?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 21

“What is one sentence I wish I could hear?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 3 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 22

“Where did I make room for myself?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 23

“What did I survive, soften, or begin?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 24

“What deserves less judgment from me?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 25

“What moment was ordinary and still good?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 26

“What can be true without being fixed tonight?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 27

“How did I protect my energy?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 28

“What did I notice with curiosity?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 4 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 29

“What would “kind enough” sound like here?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 30

“What brought even a flicker of ease?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 31

“What did my future self need from me today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 32

“What can I release from the story of this day?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 33

“What am I learning to trust?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 34

“Where did I choose gentleness over perfection?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 35

“What would I tell someone I love in this exact moment?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 5 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 36

“What is one small proof that I kept going?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 37

“What felt tender today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 38

“What did I do with care, even if no one saw it?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 39

“What is one sentence I wish I could hear?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 40

“Where did I make room for myself?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 41

“What did I survive, soften, or begin?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 42

“What deserves less judgment from me?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 6 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 43

“What moment was ordinary and still good?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 44

“What can be true without being fixed tonight?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 45

“How did I protect my energy?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 46

“What did I notice with curiosity?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 47

“What would “kind enough” sound like here?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 48

“What brought even a flicker of ease?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 49

“What did my future self need from me today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 7 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 50

“What can I release from the story of this day?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 51

“What am I learning to trust?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 52

“Where did I choose gentleness over perfection?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 53

“What would I tell someone I love in this exact moment?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 54

“What is one small proof that I kept going?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 55

“What felt tender today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 56

“What did I do with care, even if no one saw it?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 8 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 57

“What is one sentence I wish I could hear?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 58

“Where did I make room for myself?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 59

“What did I survive, soften, or begin?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 60

“What deserves less judgment from me?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 61

“What moment was ordinary and still good?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 62

“What can be true without being fixed tonight?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 63

“How did I protect my energy?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 9 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 64

“What did I notice with curiosity?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 65

“What would “kind enough” sound like here?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 66

“What brought even a flicker of ease?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 67

“What did my future self need from me today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 68

“What can I release from the story of this day?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 69

“What am I learning to trust?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 70

“Where did I choose gentleness over perfection?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 10 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 71

“What would I tell someone I love in this exact moment?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 72

“What is one small proof that I kept going?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 73

“What felt tender today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 74

“What did I do with care, even if no one saw it?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 75

“What is one sentence I wish I could hear?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 76

“Where did I make room for myself?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 77

“What did I survive, soften, or begin?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 11 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 78

“What deserves less judgment from me?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 79

“What moment was ordinary and still good?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 80

“What can be true without being fixed tonight?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 81

“How did I protect my energy?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 82

“What did I notice with curiosity?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 83

“What would “kind enough” sound like here?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 84

“What brought even a flicker of ease?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Week 12 · evidence of care

Look for evidence, not perfection.

WHAT I DID THAT MATTERED

WHAT I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD

A KIND PLAN FOR THE NEXT WEEK

Day 85

“What did my future self need from me today?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 86

“What can I release from the story of this day?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 87

“What am I learning to trust?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 88

“Where did I choose gentleness over perfection?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 89

“What would I tell someone I love in this exact moment?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Day 90

“What is one small proof that I kept going?”

WHAT FELT HARD?

WHAT DID I DO WITH CARE?

A KIND SENTENCE I CAN BELIEVE

ONE SMALL GRATITUDE

Monthly Letter 1 · patterns, not verdicts

WHAT FELT SUPPORTIVE?

WHAT FELT HARD OR UNCLEAR?

WHAT DO I WANT TO ASK, ADJUST, OR REMEMBER?

ONE WAY I CAN MAKE NEXT MONTH GENTLER

Monthly Letter 2 · patterns, not verdicts

WHAT FELT SUPPORTIVE?

WHAT FELT HARD OR UNCLEAR?

WHAT DO I WANT TO ASK, ADJUST, OR REMEMBER?

ONE WAY I CAN MAKE NEXT MONTH GENTLER

Monthly Letter 3 · patterns, not verdicts

WHAT FELT SUPPORTIVE?

WHAT FELT HARD OR UNCLEAR?

WHAT DO I WANT TO ASK, ADJUST, OR REMEMBER?

ONE WAY I CAN MAKE NEXT MONTH GENTLER

Monthly Letter 4 · patterns, not verdicts

WHAT FELT SUPPORTIVE?

WHAT FELT HARD OR UNCLEAR?

WHAT DO I WANT TO ASK, ADJUST, OR REMEMBER?

ONE WAY I CAN MAKE NEXT MONTH GENTLER

Monthly Letter 5 · patterns, not verdicts

WHAT FELT SUPPORTIVE?

WHAT FELT HARD OR UNCLEAR?

WHAT DO I WANT TO ASK, ADJUST, OR REMEMBER?

ONE WAY I CAN MAKE NEXT MONTH GENTLER

Monthly Letter 6 · patterns, not verdicts

WHAT FELT SUPPORTIVE?

WHAT FELT HARD OR UNCLEAR?

WHAT DO I WANT TO ASK, ADJUST, OR REMEMBER?

ONE WAY I CAN MAKE NEXT MONTH GENTLER

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Free write

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.

Nothing to perform here.